

Court ruling secures Google payments that safeguard Firefox

United States District Judge Amit Mehta has ruled that Google can continue to pay browser makers such as Mozilla to remain their default search engine. This decision safeguards one of the most visible open source projects, Firefox.

The ruling is part of the remedies phase in United States vs Google LLC, following Mehta's August 2024 finding that Google maintains an illegal monopoly in search, a decision still under appeal. While Google is now barred from signing exclusive contracts that force default or preloaded use of its services, it may continue non-exclusive revenue-sharing agreements.

"Google will not be barred from making payments or offering other consideration to distribution partners for preloading or placement of Google Search, Chrome, or its GenAI products," Judge Mehta wrote. He added that "cutting off payments from Google almost certainly will impose substantial — in some cases, crippling — downstream harms to distribution partners, related markets, and consumers."



For Mozilla, the judgment is crucial. Google's search deal funding makes up nearly 85% of its annual income, a lifeline that Mozilla had argued was essential to avoid putting Firefox "out of business." The ruling provides stability until at least 2026, when Mozilla's current agreement expires. Opera raised similar concerns, warning that losing such revenue "would make it hard for [it] to continue to invest in innovative solutions."

Microsoft's .NET 10 RC focuses on performance and savings

Microsoft's first release candidate (RC) of .NET 10 under an open source model comes with a 'go-live' licence that allows production use. This long-term support release is heavily focused on performance improvements, with early results showing substantial real-world savings.



Microsoft partner software engineer Stephen Toub has published a 55,000-word report detailing performance optimisations in .NET 10. Highlights include thread pool queues that now complete tasks in just 4 ms compared to 20 seconds on .NET 9, and

compression and decompression operations that run up to 65 percent faster thanks to zlib-ng integration. Gains extend across JSON processing, collection handling, JIT compilation, and cryptography.

The performance impact is evident in production. Ian Griffiths, technical fellow at Endjin, reported consistent throughput gains in his AIS.NET application, with increases of 9 percent in .NET 9 and up to 27 percent in earlier versions.

Another enterprise developer managing 20,000 servers noted, "In my company, running maybe 20K servers on .NET, we get a 10-20 percent CPU decrease every time we upgrade to the next major."

Framework updates include tweaks to ASP.NET Core and Blazor, SQL Server vector search support in Entity Framework Core, and an experimental CoreCLR runtime option for MAUI on Android. Native AOT compilation continues in development.

Despite its open source foundation, .NET still faces criticism for closed tooling. One developer remarked, "It's just a shame that an otherwise really well-rounded language still lacks first-party open source tooling. It's unbelievable that in 2025 Microsoft still locks things as essential as a debugger behind proprietary licensing."

Automatic releases AI-powered Telex for WordPress

Automatic, the parent company of WordPress.com, has unveiled Telex, an experimental AI tool designed to generate WordPress Gutenberg blocks from simple text prompts. Announced by CEO Matt Mullenweg at WordCamp US in Portland, the tool marks a strategic pivot towards AI aimed at lowering barriers to web development and extending WordPress's mission to democratise publishing.



Describing Telex as "a V0 or Lovable, but specifically for WordPress," Mullenweg positioned the project as an enabler of creativity and accessibility. He added, "At the core of it, there is a seed of something, which is so enabling." Currently available on

its own domain, the prototype has drawn mixed reviews, with community testers noting that some blocks require manual fixes.

The move carries major open source implications. Telex could disrupt the existing plugin and theme economy by allowing users to create bespoke functionality instantly,